Vice-Chancellor Prof. Dr Sudhir Krishnaswamy, who believes that the 'mix of people and infrastructure' is what allows NLSIU to remain India's top law university. "When we put together this mix of people and infrastructure, we back it up with teaching and learning practices that are among the most rigorous in the university space," adds Prof. Krishnaswamy.

On the academic front, NLSIU marked a milestone in May 2025 with the graduation of the first batch of students from the three-year LLB course started in 2022. This batch also included a Rhodes Scholar, Vibha Swaminathan, who was one of the five recipients in India of the prestigious scholarship for the year 2025.

Another milestone pertains to the interdisciplinary Master's in Public Policy (MPP) programme, which has completed a decade since its introduction in 2014. "The programme has been a significant step in NLSIU's evolution toward a multidisciplinary university, because it has formed the basis for recruitment of faculty members in policy studies and social sciences," noted the report of NLSIU's School Review Commission for 2023-24, which has suggested further hiring for the programme. So far, the MPP

CAMPUS CALLING

Strawberry Fields, the music festival, is a well-known annual event. Other activities include the inter-collegiate cultural fest LeGala and the annual theatre festival ADMIT ONE

GUEST COLUMN



PROF DR SUDHIR KRISHNASWAMY
Vice-Chancellor

Elevating Our Higher Education

Over the past three years, NLSIU has transformed its PhD programmes. First, we reshaped the PhD (Law), PhD (Public Policy) and PhD (Interdisciplinary) around four core disciplines—Law, Social Sciences, Humanities and Public Policy. The PhD's realignment along these lines will increase its rigour and improve professional opportunities for students. In 2025, we received nearly 70 per cent more PhD applications than in 2024, and made offers to students from different disciplines, including a historian, an economist, a sociologist and a lawyer.

Second, we introduced doctoral fellowships in 2025 for all selected full-time PhD scholars at NLSIU. These fellowships start at Rs 50,000 per month in the first year and include annual increments for the period of study. The fellowship stipend is higher than that received at many universities in India.

In 2024, we celebrated the 10th anniversary of our Master's Programme in Public Policy (MPP). We undertook a curriculum review process with academics, the government, civil society and professionals in the field. The revised programme will ensure that students get a lot of exposure to the world of public policy through a more intensive internship process, a client-led project, as well as the option of a client-focused capstone project in the final year of the programme. In the past two years, we have improved our student intake with the help of a rigorous admission process, and enhanced opportunities for graduates through a revamped placement process.

In 2025, NLS will launch a research fellowships programme. These fellowships will create the opportunity for the best research scholars in India and abroad to spend from six months to two years at the university, engaged in high quality research projects. These researchers will tackle the five grand challenges identified by the university—Labour and Work; Climate Justice; State Capacity and Reform; Law, Technology and Society; and Access to Justice and Legal System Reform—and other issues of urgent public concern. We will also invite applications to at least 15 research fellowship positions this July. ■

—as told to Ajay Sukumaran

"We recently celebrated the 10th anniversary of our Master's in Public Policy programme, designed to be globally competitive..."